



5G with good battery life

The Oppo Reno 3 smartphone optimises for higher battery life by choosing the right antenna to connect with <https://digit.in/jan20-49>



Remote drone tracking

The FAA has announced a new system that will allow comprehensive nationwide tracking of UAVs <https://digit.in/jan20-50>

HP Spectre x360 13

The best Spectre ever built

The latest HP Spectre x360 13, sees a massive reduction in the laptop's top and bottom bezels. It also comes with Intel's 10th Gen Ice Lake U (10-nano-metre) CPU and 4G LTE connectivity. Let's take a look.

Build and design

The Spectre continues to employ the same angular design with faceted "gem-cut" edges on the back side. The body is made of CNC-machined aluminium with dual chamfering on all sides.

Opening the lid, which is unfortunately a two-hand job, reveals a glossy 13.3-inch touchscreen panel with extremely slim black bezels. With this model, HP has brought the height of the top bezel from 17.35 mm to an astonishing 5.85 mm. The unit comes with a 13.3-inch Full-HD HP BrightView WLED-backlit touchscreen panel with Corning Gorilla Glass NBT protection.

Keyboard and Touchpad

HP has redesigned the keycaps to provide a shallow but highly effective dish. This makes finding keys on the laptop's keyboard much easier than before. HP keys have been traditionally flat, so this is a first for the Spectre. On the minus side, the keycaps are a tad tiny for large hands and the extra column on the right (though useful for text manipulation) offsets the entire keyboard by a few critical millimetres. The Spectre x360 13 employs a proper Windows 10-recognised precision touchpad.

Performance

The HP Spectre x360 13 is one of India's first few devices to be powered by Intel's 10th Gen Core i7-1065G7 (Ice Lake U) CPU, which is a 10-nm



Price
₹1,58,990



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Quad-core chip with a Turbo clock speed of 3.90 GHz. Our review unit was complemented by 16 GB of RAM, and 512 GB of storage on an Intel Optane H10 chip, which combines traditional Optane technology and quad-level cell NAND technology for even faster

solid-state storage. Handling graphics was the new integrated Iris Plus GPU.

The Spectre x360 13 review unit bagged commendable scores on our CPU and GPU benchmark tests. Some of its GPU test scores were higher than those scored by the Lenovo IdeaPad C340, a mid-range convertible laptop with a dedicated Nvidia GeForce MX230 graphics card. On PCMark 8's Accelerated Creative test, the review unit took home 4295 points, which is ahead of its own score from earlier this year by nearly 500 points. On 3DMark's Fire Strike and Cloud Gate, the review unit walked away with 2605 and 13263 points, respectively. Those are the highest scores we've seen on any convertible laptop this year. Surprisingly, the Spectre x360 13 didn't beat the much cheaper IdeaPad C340 on our storage speed test despite the new tech boost from the Intel.

The HP Spectre x360 13's effortlessly handles everyday home and work scenarios. If anything, the laptop's single CPU fan could have been a little quieter. In summary, the HP Spectre

x360 13 is a fine device for everyday computing whether it's work or play.

4G LTE Connectivity

The laptop is equipped with an internal Intel XMM 7560 1Gbps-capable 4G LTE modem. There's a nano-SIM card tray on the left side of the device for physical SIM authentication along with support for dual eSIM connectivity in certain regions. The laptop should work with most Indian carriers as long as there's no PIN-based lock applied to the SIM card.

Battery

The Spectre x360 13 packs a quad-cell 60 Wh lithium-ion polymer battery, which is slightly smaller than the unit on the previous model. On our standard battery benchmark test, the review unit lasted 4 hours, 57 minutes. That's not only a new record score for HP's Spectre series in our books but also the highest score we have seen this entire year in the category of convertible laptops. The only other laptop to score in the same range as the new 13 is the Asus ZenBook Flip 13 (UX362) at 4 hours, 53 minutes. Though it runs on the latest Intel 10th Gen chip and employs a 1W low-power LCD panel, the Spectre x360 13 is not listed as an Intel Project Athena model, which means it's impractical to expect 9+ hours of web browsing on battery.

Verdict

The HP Spectre x360 13 rights most of the wrongs from previous Spectre models to come up as the best of its kind yet. It's one heck of a premium convertible laptop if you're willing to spend close to ₹2 lakh.

—Vignesh Giridharan

SPECIFICATIONS

CHIPSET: Intel Core i7-1065G7 | MEMORY SUPPORT: 16 GB 3200 MHz DDR4 | NETWORK: Intel XMM 7560 + Wi-Fi 6 AX 201 | AUDIO: Bang & Olufsen dual speakers | SATA: 4-cell 60 Wh Li-ion | WEIGHT: 1.27 kg | DIMENSIONS (LXWXD): 306 mm x 194.5 x 16.9 mm | WARRANTY: 1 year.

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